PEW RESEARCH CENTER NEWS INTEREST INDEX
SEPTEMBER 15-18, 2011 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,006

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. The debate in Washington over President Obama's jobs legislation					
September 15-18, 2011	31	28	19	21	2
TREND FOR COMPARISON:					
September 8-11, 2011: *Barack Obama's speech about jobs to a joint session of Congress*	28	18	17	36	1
December 2-5, 2010: *The debate in Washington over the federal income tax cuts passed when George W. Bush was president*	39	26	17	17	1
September 16-19, 2010: *The debate in Washington over competing Democratic and Republican tax plans*	21	24	21	34	*
September 9-12, 2010	16	19	22	42	1
May 8-11, 2009: *The debate in Washington over the federal budget*	22	28	19	31	*
March 27-30, 2009: *Debate over Barack Obama's budget proposal*	28	34	18	19	1
March 6-9, 2009: *Obama proposing a $630 billion fund for overhauling health care*	41	32	13	14	*
February 27-March 2, 2009: *Barack Obama's budget proposal for next year that raises taxes on wealthy Americans and increases spending on health care, education and other programs*	47	34	9	10	*
February 27-March 2, 2009: *The Obama administration's plan to help homeowners facing foreclosure which could cost as much as $275 billion dollars*	31	36	19	13	1
February 20-23, 2009: *The $780 billion economic stimulus legislation approved by Congress and signed into law by President Obama*	41	37	14	8	*
February 13-16, 2009: *Congress passing Barack Obama's economic stimulus plan*	50	32	13	5	*
February 6-9, 2009: *The debate in Congress over Barack Obama's economic stimulus plan*	41	33	15	11	*
January 30-February 2, 2009	36	29	22	13	*
January 16-19, 2009: *Debate in Washington over what the government should do about the nation's economic problems*	35	33	17	15	*
December 19-22, 2008: *The Bush administration's plan to provide billions in emergency loans to U.S. automakers*	37	33	16	13	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
December 12-15, 2008: *The debate over a government bailout for the U.S. auto industry*	40	33	18	9	*
December 5-8, 2008: *The debate in Congress over a government bailout for the U.S. auto industry*	34	38	17	11	*
November 21-24, 2008	41	26	17	15	1
October 3-6, 2008: *The debate in Washington over a plan to use government funds to stabilize financial markets*	62	26	7	5	*
September 26-29, 2008	60	22	10	8	*
September 12-15, 2008: *The federal government taking control of the mortgage companies Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac*	28	35	19	17	1
March 20-24, 2008: *The buyout of Wall Street investment bank Bear Stearns*	21	26	21	32	*
February 8-11, 2008: *President Bush and Congress agreeing on an economic Stimulus plan*	22	33	23	21	1
January 25-28, 2008	24	36	19	21	*
February, 2003: *George W. Bush's tax cut and economic stimulus plan*	26	33	23	16	2
February, 2003	26	33	23	16	2
January, 2003	28	34	21	15	2
February, 2002: *The debate in Congress over George W. Bush's budget and tax cut plan*	17	31	28	23	1
April, 2001	24	38	20	18	*
February, 2001: *George W. Bush's tax cut plan*	31	35	19	14	1
August, 1997: *The debate in Washington about the federal budget*	14	34	25	26	1
May, 1997	16	38	23	22	1
February, 1997	19	28	22	29	2
March, 1996	24	35	23	18	*
January, 1996	32	42	17	9	*
September, 1995	20	35	27	18	*
August, 1995: *The debate in Congress over the federal budget*	18	34	27	20	1
February, 1995: *The debate in Congress over the Balanced Budget Amendment*	12	31	28	28	1
August, 1993: The debate in Congress over Bill Clinton's budget bill	30	36	21	13	*
June, 1993	12	38	31	18	1
February, 1993: *Bill Clinton's economic plan*	49	36	10	5	*
September, 1992 *(RV)*: *George Bush's plan to improve the economy by cutting government spending and cutting taxes*	28	44	18	9	1
August, 1989: *Passage of a bill to bailout ailing savings and loan institutions*	26	30	20	23	1
b. A government report showing that 46 million Americans live in poverty					
September 15-18, 2011	28	27	20	25	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
November 6-9, 2009: *Reports about the rising unemployment rate*	34	29	22	14	*
May 8-11, 2009	33	33	17	17	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
April 3-6, 2009	36	37	16	11	*
March 6-9, 2009	42	33	13	11	1
January 9-12, 2009	45	34	14	7	*
December 5-8, 2008	40	33	17	10	*
November 7-10, 2008	39	32	17	12	*
February 6-9, 2009	44	36	11	9	*
c. Attacks on the U.S. embassy and NATO's headquarters in Afghanistan					
September 15-18, 2011	16	24	22	37	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
September 1-4, 2011: *The current situation and events in Afghanistan*	17	32	26	25	*
August 11-14, 2011: *The 30 U.S. troops killed in Afghanistan in a helicopter attack*	39	33	13	14	1
June 30-July 3, 2011: *The current situation and events in Afghanistan*	22	34	24	20	1
June 23-26, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about U.S. troop levels in Afghanistan*	27	32	20	20	1
June 2-5, 2011: *The current situation and events in Afghanistan*	20	35	23	21	1
March 3-6, 2011: *U.S. airmen killed at an airport in Frankfort, Germany*	16	22	19	42	1
December 16-19, 2010: *The Obama administration's review of the Afghanistan war strategy*	17	26	25	31	1
December 9-12, 2010: *The current situation and events in Afghanistan*	24	31	22	22	1
November 18-21, 2010	27	33	21	18	1
October 21-24, 2010	21	34	23	21	1
October 7-10, 2010	21	36	20	22	1
September 30-October 3, 2010	23	37	23	15	1
September 23-26, 2010	29	40	19	11	1
September 9-12, 2010	30	33	20	17	*
July 29-August 1, 2010	34	35	22	9	*
July 15-18, 2010	22	33	23	22	*
July 8-11, 2010	23	32	24	20	1
July 1-5, 2010	29	34	23	14	1
June 24-27, 2010: *General Stanley McChrystal resigning as head of U.S. forces in Afghanistan after being quoted criticizing President Obama and his Afghanistan strategy*	28	31	19	21	1
June 17-20, 2010	21	30	27	22	*
May 20-23, 2010	22	33	25	20	*
April 9-12, 2010	21	29	27	22	1
February 19-22, 2010: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan*	24	36	21	19	*
January 8-11, 2010: *Suicide bombing that killed seven Americans at a CIA base in Afghanistan*	24	31	27	17	1
December 11-14, 2009: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan*	35	33	18	13	*
December 4-7, 2009: *President Obama's decision to send more U.S. troops to Afghanistan*	43	33	14	8	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
November 20-23, 2009: *The debate over whether to send more troops to Afghanistan*	29	31	17	22	1
November 13-16, 2009	29	28	20	22	1
November 6-9, 2009: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan*	22	35	24	18	*
October 30-November 2, 2009	24	32	21	22	*
October 23-26, 2009	32	29	21	18	*
October 16-19, 2009	25	31	20	24	*
September 25-28, 2009: *The debate over whether to send more troops to Afghanistan*	27	40	17	16	*
September 18-21, 2009: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan*	26	33	25	16	*
September 11-14, 2009	25	35	22	18	1
September 3-6, 2009	23	33	23	21	0
August 7-10, 2009	24	32	23	21	1
March 20-23, 2009	24	32	22	22	*
February 20-23, 2009: *The Obama administration's decision to send 17,000 additional U.S. troops to Afghanistan*	27	29	24	19	1
January 30-February 2, 2009: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan*	26	34	24	16	*
January 2-4, 2009	22	33	23	21	1
October 24-27, 2008	28	32	22	17	1
October 10-13, 2008: *The military effort in Afghanistan against Taliban fighters*	19	34	29	18	*
September 12-15, 2008	21	34	25	19	1
August 29-31, 2008	18	27	32	23	*
August 19-22, 2008: *A terrorist bombing at the U.S. embassy in Yemen*	15	27	31	26	1
July 18-21, 2008: *The military effort in Afghanistan against Taliban fighters*	27	33	24	16	*
July 11-14, 2008	19	28	29	23	1
July 3-7, 2008	19	28	32	21	*
June 20-23, 2008	20	30	30	20	*
March 2-5, 2007: *A bombing in Afghanistan near where Vice President Cheney was staying*	19	33	26	21	1
Late July, 2002: *The U.S. military effort in Afghanistan*	41	38	13	7	1
June, 2002	38	32	20	9	1
April, 2002	39	39	13	8	1
Early April, 2002	45	37	12	5	1
February, 2002	47	39	8	5	1
9January, 2002	51	35	9	4	1
December, 2001	44	38	12	5	1
Mid-November, 2001	49	36	11	3	1
Early November, 2001	45	36	12	6	1
Mid-October, 2001	51	35	10	3	1
October, 2000: *The terrorist attack on the navy warship U.S.S. Cole*	44	35	12	9	*
August, 1998: *The bombing at U.S. embassies in Kenya and Tanzania*	27	37	18	18	*
July, 1996: *The bombing of a military base in Saudi Arabia*	32	36	20	12	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
d. The debt crisis in Greece and other European countries					
September 15-18, 2011	16	23	24	37	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
August 18-21, 2011: *The debate among European leaders on how to address the region's debt crisis*	12	21	22	44	1
August 11-14, 2011: *Riots in London and other parts of* Britain	17	28	21	32	1
June 30-July 3, 2011: *The financial crisis and violent protests in Greece*	14	22	23	39	1
June 16-19, 2011	10	20	25	45	1
May 13-16, 2010: *A trillion-dollar bailout package for European governments facing debt problems*	21	26	24	28	2
May 7-10, 2010: *The financial crisis in Greece and violent protests there*	19	23	26	31	*
April 30-May 3, 2010: *The financial crisis in Greece*	6	15	28	51	1
October, 1998: *Financial instability around the world*	32	40	19	9	*
September, 1998: *Economic and political instability in Russia*	18	30	28	24	*
Late August, 1998: *Economic problems in Russia*	8	22	29	41	*
January, 1998: *The deepening financial crisis in many Asian countries*	15	25	27	33	*
March, 1995: *The financial and political instability in Mexico*	12	28	30	29	1
e. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections					
September 15-18, 2011	24	28	21	27	1
September 8-11, 2011	22	26	21	31	*
September 1-4, 2011	22	23	22	32	1
August 25-28, 2011	22	22	22	33	1
August 18-21, 2011	27	26	19	28	1
August 11-14, 2011	19	24	20	36	1
August 4-7, 2011	18	21	22	37	1
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
2008 Election					
October 31-November 3, 2008: *News about the presidential election*	57	29	9	5	*
October 24-27, 2008: *News about candidates for the 2008 presidential election*	44	36	11	8	1
October 17-20, 2008	61	28	7	4	*
October 10-13, 2008	52	31	12	5	*
October 3-6, 2008	57	31	8	4	*
September 26-29, 2008	56	29	10	5	*
September 19-22, 2008	47	33	14	6	*
September 12-15, 2008	40	38	14	7	1
September 5-8, 2008	45	39	12	4	*
August 29-31, 2008	45	32	15	8	*
August 22-25, 2008	31	36	22	11	*
August 15-18, 2008	25	41	19	14	1
August 8-11, 2008	27	38	22	13	*
August 1-4, 2008	30	42	19	9	*
July 25-28, 2008	30	34	21	15	*
July 18-21, 2008	30	35	21	14	*
July 11-14, 2008	28	34	22	15	1
July 3-7, 2008	25	35	23	17	*
June 27-30, 2008	39	33	18	10	*
June 20-23, 2008	28	38	22	12	*
June 13-16, 2008	35	35	20	10	*
June 6-9, 2008	38	35	17	10	*
May 30-June 2, 2008	30	35	21	14	*
May 22-25, 2008	32	37	20	11	*
May 16-19, 2008	33	37	19	10	1
May 9-12, 2008	35	36	18	11	*
May 2-5, 2008	27	35	23	14	1
April 25-28, 2008	34	37	18	11	*
April 18-21, 2008	29	41	19	10	1
April 11-14, 2008	31	37	22	10	*
April 4-7, 2008	33	36	17	14	*
March 28-31, 2008	31	41	18	10	*
March 20-24, 2008	34	37	18	11	*
March 14-17, 2008	40	37	16	7	*
March 7-10, 2008	39	36	15	9	1
February 29-March 3, 2008	43	34	14	9	*
February 22-25, 2008	42	37	13	8	*
February 15-18, 2008	44	36	10	10	*
February 8-11, 2008	39	37	15	9	0
February 1-4, 2008	37	35	16	12	*
January 25-28, 2008	36	37	14	12	1
January 18-21, 2008	36	34	18	12	*
January 11-14, 2008: *News about the New Hampshire primaries and the presidential campaign*	32	31	19	17	1
January 4-7, 2008: *News about candidates for the 2008 presidential election*	33	36	19	11	1
December 14-17, 2007	25	34	22	19	*
December 7-10, 2007	24	35	22	19	*
November 30 – December 3, 2007	23	35	23	19	*
November 23-26, 2007	20	33	26	20	1
November 16-19, 2007	26	33	21	19	1
November 9-12, 2007	21	33	25	21	*
November 2-5, 2007	27	30	21	21	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
October 26-29, 2007	21	34	26	19	*
October 19-22, 2007	23	32	22	23	*
October 12-15, 2007	13	31	26	30	*
October 5-8, 2007	22	30	24	24	*
September 28 – October 1, 2007	21	34	25	20	*
September 21-24, 2007	24	31	22	23	*
September 14-17, 2007	22	31	24	23	*
September 7-10, 2007	18	34	26	22	*
August 30-September 2, 2007	19	35	21	25	*
August 24-27, 2007	22	28	24	26	*
August 17-20, 2007	19	27	24	30	*
August 10-13, 2007	23	32	21	24	*
August 3-6, 2007	19	31	25	25	*
July 27-30, 2007	19	32	22	26	1
July 20-23, 2007	16	26	30	27	1
July 13-16, 2007	17	29	27	27	*
July 6-9, 2007	24	29	24	22	1
June 29-July 2, 2007	20	32	25	23	*
June 22-25, 2007	18	31	21	30	*
June 15-18, 2007	17	32	26	25	*
June 8-11, 2007	19	30	24	26	1
June 1-4, 2007	16	27	32	24	1
May 24-27, 2007	22	33	23	22	*
May 18-21, 2007	18	31	24	27	*
May 11-14, 2007	18	30	23	28	1
May 4-7, 2007	23	34	21	21	1
April 27-30, 2007	14	30	29	26	1
April 20-23, 2007	18	28	27	27	*
April 12-16, 2007	18	28	27	27	*
April 5-9, 2007	25	30	26	19	*
March 30-April 2, 2007	20	29	27	23	1
March 23-26, 2007	20	32	22	26	*
March 16-19, 2007	15	28	29	27	1
March 9-12, 2007	24	30	23	23	*
March 2-5, 2007	19	31	26	23	1
February 23-26, 2007	22	33	24	21	*
February 16-19, 2007	18	32	22	27	1
February 9-12, 2007	24	30	24	21	1
February 2-5, 2007	24	36	22	18	*
January 26-29, 2007	24	33	23	20	*
January 19-22, 2007: *Recent announcements by prominent Democrats about plans to run for president in 2008*	24	27	22	26	1
2004 Election					
November, 2004: *News about the presidential election*	47	35	10	7	1
Mid-October, 2004: *News about candidates for the 2004 presidential election*	46	30	12	11	1
September, 2004	40	34	14	11	1
August, 2004	32	38	16	14	*
July, 2004	29	37	18	15	1
June, 2004	28	34	19	18	1
April, 2004	31	33	19	16	1
Mid-March, 2004	35	34	18	13	*
Late February, 2004 **(GAP)**	24	40	23	12	1
Early February, 2004: *The race for the Democratic presidential nomination*	29	37	20	13	1
Mid-January, 2004	16	30	27	26	1
Early January, 2004	14	32	30	23	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
December, 2003	16	26	27	30	1
November, 2003	11	26	34	28	1
October, 2003	12	27	28	32	1
September, 2003	17	25	30	27	1
Mid-August, 2003	12	27	27	33	1
May, 2003	8	19	31	41	1
January, 2003: *Recent announcements by prominent Democrats about plans to run for president in 2004*	14	28	29	28	1
2000 Election					
Early November, 2000: *News about the presidential election*	33	41	15	10	1
Mid-October, 2000: *News about the presidential election campaign*	36	35	17	11	1
Early October, 2000	35	35	19	10	1
September, 2000	22	42	21	15	1
July, 2000: *News about candidates for the 2000 presidential election*	21	38	20	20	1
June, 2000	23	32	23	21	1
May, 2000	18	33	26	23	*
April, 2000	18	39	22	20	1
March, 2000	26	41	19	13	1
February, 2000	26	36	21	17	*
January, 2000	19	34	28	18	1
December, 1999	16	36	24	23	1
October, 1999	17	32	28	22	1
September, 1999	15	31	33	20	1
July, 1999	15	38	24	22	1
June, 1999	11	25	29	34	1
1996 Election					
November, 1996: *News about the presidential election*	28	42	19	10	*
October, 1996: *News about the presidential election campaign*	31	39	18	12	*
Early September, 1996	24	36	23	17	*
July, 1996	22	40	23	14	1
April, 1996	23	35	25	17	*
March, 1996 *News about the Republican presidential candidates*	26	41	20	13	*
January, 1996	10	34	31	24	1
October, 1995	12	36	30	22	*
August, 1995	13	34	28	25	*
June, 1995	11	31	31	26	1
1992 Election					
October, 1992: *News about the presidential election (RVs)*	55	36	8	2	0
September, 1992: *News about the presidential election campaign*	42	37	13	8	*
August, 1992: *News about the presidential election* (RVs)	36	51	11	2	0
July, 1992: *News about the presidential campaign*	20	45	26	9	*
May, 1992: *The presidential election campaign*	32	44	16	8	*
March, 1992: *The race for the Democratic presidential nomination*	35	40	16	9	*
March, 1992: *The race for the Republican presidential nomination*	25	40	22	13	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
February 1992: *The Democratic primary in New Hampshire*	19	31	26	24	*
February, 1992: *The Republican primary in New Hampshire*	19	31	26	23	1
January, 1992: *News about the Democratic candidates for the presidential nomination*	11	25	36	27	1
December, 1991	10	28	32	30	*
October, 1991	12	26	31	29	2
October, 1988: *News about the presidential campaign in 1988* (RVs)	43	44	11	2	*
1988 Election					
August, 1988 (RVs)	39	45	13	3	*
May, 1988 (RVs)	22	46	23	6	3
November, 1987: *News about the Democratic candidates for the presidential nomination*	15	28	35	21	1
November, 1987: *News about the Republican candidates for the presidential nomination*	13	28	36	22	1
September, 1987: *Coverage of the Democratic* and *Republican candidates for the presidential nomination*	14	34	37	14	1
f. Recent ups and downs in the stock market					
September 15-18, 2011	24	27	18	30	1
August 11-14, 2011	32	28	16	24	1
July 28-31, 2011	18	23	20	39	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
January 27-30, 2011: *Recent gains in the stock market*	13	17	20	49	1
August 12-15, 2010: *Recent ups and downs in the stock market*	17	21	20	42	1
March 26-29, 2010	13	23	23	40	1
October 16-19, 2009: *Recent gains in the stock market*	15	23	19	43	*
July 24-27, 2009	23	25	24	28	*
March 13-16, 2009	38	31	14	17	0
March 6-9, 2009: *Recent major drops in the U.S. stock market*	35	31	15	19	*
February 20-23, 2009	31	32	20	17	*
November 21-24, 2008	50	23	15	12	*
October 17-20, 2008: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market*	54	31	9	6	*
October 10-13, 2008: *Recent major drops in the U.S. stock market*	59	26	9	6	*
July 3-7, 2008: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market*	22	29	23	26	*
March 14-17, 2008	25	31	23	21	*
January 25-28, 2008	29	28	19	23	1
August 17-20, 2007	21	24	22	33	*
July 27-30, 2007	15	26	21	37	1
March 2-5, 2007: *The recent drop in the U.S. stock market*	21	28	25	26	*
Early September, 2002: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market*	27	30	20	22	1
Late July, 2002	33	33	15	18	1
March, 2001	27	27	18	27	1
Mid-October, 2000	20	26	23	31	1
April, 2000	18	28	23	31	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
Early April, 2000	19	29	20	32	*
March, 2000	23	29	21	26	1
March, 1999	18	29	22	31	*
January, 1999	24	28	19	28	1
Early September, 1998	32	31	20	17	*
Mid-August, 1998	17	23	21	39	*
January, 1998	21	25	23	31	*
Mid-November, 1997	25	36	18	20	1
Early November, 1997: *Thinking about last Monday when the stock market dropped, how closely did you follow what was happening?*	16	29	22	33	*

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? [**DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

Sep 15-18 2011	
23	The debate in Washington over President Obama's jobs legislation
13	News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections
11	Recent ups and downs in the stock market
7	A government report showing that 46 million Americans live in poverty
5	The debt crisis in Greece and other European countries
5	Attacks on the U.S. embassy and NATO's headquarters in Afghanistan
16	Some other story **(VOL.)**
20	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:

On another subject…

PEWWP.1 In the dispute between Israel and the Palestinians, which side do you sympathize with more, Israel or the Palestinians?

	Israel	Palestinians	**(VOL.)** Both	**(VOL.)** Neither	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
September 15-18, 2011	40	10	3	21	25
FOR COMPARISON:[1]					
May 25-30, 2011	48	11	4	15	21
Apr 21-26, 2010	49	16	4	12	19
Oct 28-Nov 8, 2009	51	12	4	14	19
January 7-11, 2009	49	11	5	15	20
May, 2007	49	11	5	17	18
August, 2006	52	11	5	15	17
July, 2006	44	9	5	20	22
May, 2006	48	13	4	14	20
Late October, 2005	43	17	5	16	19
July, 2005	37	12	5	19	27
July, 2004	40	13	7	18	22
Late February, 2004	46	12	8	15	19
Mid-July, 2003	41	13	8	18	20
June, 2002	46	12	6	19	17
April, 2002	41	13	6	21	19
Mid-October, 2001	47	10	8	18	17

[1] Non-response to questions PEWWP.1-PEWWP.3 was unusually high on this survey. These questions are normally asked in the middle of surveys with substantial political content preceding them.

PEWWP.1 CONTINUED…

	Israel	Palestinians	(VOL.) Both	(VOL.) Neither	(VOL.) DK/Ref
Early September, 2001	40	17	6	23	14
September, 1997	48	13	5	16	18
September, 1993	45	21	3	18	12
Chicago CFR 1990	34	14	7	26	20
Chicago CFR 1982	40	17	8	19	16
Chicago CFR 1978[2]	45	14	9	18	15

ASK ALL:

PEWWP.2 Thinking about the situation in the Middle East these days, do you think Barack Obama is **[RANDOMIZE:** favoring Israel too much; favoring the Palestinians too much**]** or striking about the right balance?

		FOR COMPARISON:[1]			
Sep 15-18 2011		May 25-28 2011	Apr 21-26 2010	Oct 28-Nov 8 2009	Jun 10-14 2009
5	Favoring Israel too much	6	7	7	6
20	Favoring the Palestinians too much	21	21	16	17
37	Striking about the right balance	50	47	51	62
38	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	24	25	26	14

ASK ALL:

PEWWP.3 Do you think the United States should or should not recognize Palestine as an independent nation?

		FOR COMPARISON:[1]	
		ABC/Wash Post April 2002	***ABC*** Oct 2001
Sep 15-18 2011			
42	Should	68	55
26	Should not	21	28
32	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	11	17

ASK ALL:

PEW.3 How much if anything, have you heard about each of the following? Have you heard a lot, a little or nothing at all? **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**

	A lot	A little	Nothing at all	(VOL.) DK/Ref
a. The planned debate at the United Nations over the status of the Palestinian territories				
September 15-18, 2011	10	38	51	1
b. Texas Governor Rick Perry calling Social Security a Ponzi scheme				
September 15-18, 2011	36	29	34	1
c. Republicans winning two special congressional races in New York and Nevada				
September 15-18, 2011	22	32	45	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:				
July 2-5, 2009: *The Court declaring Al Franken the winner of Minnesota's U.S. Senate race*	16	43	41	*

[2] In the 1978 Chicago Council on Foreign Relations survey conducted by the Gallup Organization, results are based on respondents who said they had "heard or read about the situation in the Middle East", which represented 87% of the public. As a context note, in both the 1978 and 1982 CCFR/Gallup surveys, this question followed a broader question: "In the Middle East situation, are your sympathies more with Israel or more with the Arab nations?" and in 1982, a question regarding "U.S. military aid and arms sales to Israel".

PEW.3 CONTINUED…

	A lot	A little	Nothing at all	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
d. Republican candidates debating mandatory vaccination for young girls against a sexually transmitted virus				
September 15-18, 2011	31	30	39	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:				
April 24-27, 2009: *The federal government's decision allowing over-the-counter sale of the Plan B contraceptive to women as young as 17*	19	46	35	*